

2c. Content of: Deconstructing texts for performance (41–48)

Learners will explore the creative possibilities of staging the chosen performance text. This component is assessed through a written exam but preparation must consist of practical study.

Learners are required to explore the performance text practically through the role of the director. Learners will deconstruct the text and explore how any of its scenes can be staged and performed for an audience. Learners will analyse and interpret the performance text in depth.

Learners are required to study **one** performance text from the following:

The performance texts for examination until 2026 are:

- *Antigone* - Sophocles (Jean Anouilh)
- *Cloud Nine* - Caryl Churchill
- *Earthquakes in London* - Mike Bartlett
- *Stockholm* - Bryony Lavery
- *Sweeney Todd: The Demon Barber of Fleet Street* - Patrick Quentin/Stephen Sondheim
- *The Crucible* - Arthur Miller
- *The Visit* - Friedrich Durrenmatt
- *Woza Albert!* - Percy Mtwa/ Mbongeni Ngema/ Barney Simon

The performance texts for **first teaching from 2025** and **examination from 2027** are:

- *Antigone* – Sophocles (Jean Anouilh)
- *Earthquakes in London* – Mike Bartlett
- *Lovesong* – Abi Morgan
- *Nell Gwynn* – Jessica Swale
- *Nine Night* – Natasha Gordon
- *Sweeney Todd: The Demon Barber of Fleet Street* – Patrick Quentin/Stephen Sondheim
- *The Crucible* – Arthur Miller
- *The Visit* – Friedrich Durrenmatt

Learners are not permitted to have access to the text in the examination.

All of the set texts in this component **cannot** be performed for assessment in the 'Exploring and performing texts' or the 'Practitioners in practice' components.

The set texts will be reviewed after three years and may be subject to change. If a text is to be removed from the list and replaced with another text, centres will be notified a year in advance.

Deconstructing texts for performance		
Learners should:	Learners should know and understand:	Learners should be able to:
• analyse and interpret their chosen performance text in depth from the perspective of a director.	• the production process and the role of a director • directorial methods and techniques in order to establish a vision and make creative and artistic choices • the impact vision has when staging the performance text • the performance text narrative and its characters from practical exploration of the text • how the performance text has been constructed including:	• demonstrate a clear understanding of the role of the director • show how methods and techniques can support interpretations of the creative possibilities for staging the performance text • articulate an informed, creative and personal interpretation on how the performance text can be communicated to an audience

Learners should:	Learners should know and understand:	Learners should be able to:
	◦ structure ◦ language ◦ character construction • the playwright's intentions and original performance context • the social, cultural and historical context surrounding the performance text.	• make directorial decisions for staging the performance text • use accurate subject-specific terminology.